CSA Cup Grand Junction — Referee Quick Guide

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Game basics

U9–U14 recreational games, played under current FIFA Laws of the Game with the CSA changes below. One certified referee per game when possible.

Item	U9–U10	U11–U12	U13–U14
Format	7v7, roster max 14	9v9, roster max 16	11v11, roster max 18
Minimum to start or continue	5 players (one must be the goalkeeper)	6 players (one must be the goalkeeper)	7 players (one must be the goalkeeper)
Match length	2 x 20 minutes	2 x 25 minutes	2 x 35 minutes
Ball	Size 4	Size 4	Size 5
Penalty mark	8 yards from goal line	8 yards from goal line	12 yards from goal line
Free kick distance	8 yards	8 yards	10 yards

These apply to every age group:

- **Ball:** each team supplies one; referee picks.
- **Overtime:** none, ever.
- **Tied semifinal or final:** straight to kicks from the mark.
- **Added time:** only for serious injuries, not trifling stoppages. Keep to the field schedule.

Before the match

Check-in and kickoff

- Kick off at the scheduled time. Teams get a **15-minute grace period**.
- A team not ready with at least the minimum number of properly uniformed, checked-in players (5, 6 or 7 by age group) after the grace period **forfeits** (recorded 3-0).

- The referee records on the game report the name of any suspended player or coach the team reports.

Rosters and bench

- No guest players. A player can play for only one team in the tournament.
- Max **4 coaches/team staff** on the sideline. Each must be on the frozen cup roster or have a current PlayMetrics coaching pass.

Uniforms and equipment

- Home team (listed first on the schedule) wears **dark**; visitors wear **white or light**.
- Goalkeeper colors must differ from both teams and the referee.
- **Shin guards required.**
- **No earrings or jewelry** — taping or bandaging earrings is not allowed.
- Allowed only if taped to the body: religious medals, medical tags.
- Casts, splints and braces: the referee's call. Allowed if not dangerous or padded with soft material.

Field setup

- Both teams on the same side. Each team area starts 10 yards from the halfway line and runs 12 yards toward its goal.
- Spectators on the opposite side, at least 5 feet from the touchlines and goal lines. Nobody behind the goals without Tournament Director approval.
- Video cameras (e.g., Veo) on the spectator side, base at least 4 yards from the touchline.
- **Not allowed:** drones, horns, whistles, large megaphones, artificial noisemakers.

During the match

Substitutions

- Unlimited subs at **any stoppage**, with the referee's permission.
- A cautioned player may be subbed at the time of the caution; the opponent may then sub **one** player.
- Players enter only at the **halfway line**, after the outgoing player has fully left and the referee signals them on.
- Outgoing players may leave at the nearest boundary to save time.

- A sent-off player **cannot be replaced**. The team plays short for the rest of the game.
- If a team drops below its minimum (5 at U9–U10, 6 at U11–U12, 7 at U13–U14), the game cannot continue.

Sideline control

- Players and coaches stay in their team area, behind any spectator line or 5+ feet from the touchline.
- Exceptions: subs warming up, or staff the referee calls on to help an injured player.
- Spectators in the wrong area get **one warning**, then may be ejected.

Injuries and concussions

- A suspected head injury is evaluated by the on-site medical trainer, who reports to Cup staff.
- That player cannot return until cleared by a medical professional.

Discipline

Send-off consequences (the referee reports; Cup staff enforce)

Reason for send-off	Suspension
Foul/abusive language, or persistent misconduct after a caution	Next tournament game
Violent conduct	At least the next 2 tournament games
Bench personnel dismissed	That team's next game, and no Cup role with any team until served

- Unserved suspensions carry to the player's next CSA league game or next Cup enrollment.
- A dismissed coach or spectator may also cost the team 1 standings point (decided by Cup staff).

Ejected coaches and spectators

- Must move at least **100 yards** from the field within **5 minutes** of notice.
- If they don't, **abandon the match**. Their team forfeits (3-0 or the current score, whichever favors the opponent more).

Abuse of officials

- Harassment or insults toward referees or staff are not tolerated. Coaches are responsible for their supporters.
- Report it; the Tournament Committee and CSA handle discipline.

Final say

- **No protests.** The referee's on-field decisions are final and cannot be appealed.
- Situations these rules don't cover go to the Tournament or Site Director.

Results, forfeits and weather

- **Group games** can end in a tie. No overtime, no kicks.
- **Semifinals and finals** tied after regulation go straight to kicks from the mark.
- **Forfeits** (no-show or not ready after 15 minutes) are recorded as 3-0.
- **Weather:** play stops for rain, cold, high wind or lightning. When the siren sounds, clear the field; play resumes on the next siren. Only the Tournament Director cancels, shortens or moves games.
- **Stopped games:** if play doesn't resume and at least one half was completed, the score at the stoppage stands.

Standings (3 points win, 1 tie) and tiebreakers are handled by tournament staff, not the referee.

After the match

- [ ] Complete the game card in full, including the final score.
- [ ] List any suspended players or coaches who sat out (if the team told the referee).
- [ ] Tell CSA tournament staff about every send-off (players, coaches, spectators).
- [ ] Submit a supplemental game report for any send-off, abandonment or unusual incident.
- [ ] **Complete the game report in Assignr.com.** Referees are not paid for the game until it is submitted.